

News

US returns Benin Bronzes stolen by British colonial forces

Thousands of Benin Bronzes are scattered in museums worldwide after being looted by Britain in the late 19th century.

A bronze sculpture called the Head of a King or Oba is among 31 culturally precious objects returned to the Nigerian government on October 11, 2022 [Erik Gould/RISD Museum via AP]

12 Oct 2022

A bronze sculpture of a West African king that was in the collection of a Rhode Island

AL JAZEERA · 12 OCTOBER 2022



Breaking: FG Issues Gazette Recognising Ownership, Vesting Custody of Repatriated Looted Artefacts in Oba of Benin

BREAKING | 4 years ago

The Federal Government has issued a gazette recognizing ownership and vesting custody and management of repatriated Benin Artefacts in the Oba of Benin.

With the official gazette, the dispute over the ownership, custody and

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WORLD

Return of Benin Bronzes delayed after Nigerian president's decree

By MACDONALD DZIRUTWE
Thursday, 11 May 2023 | 1:50 AM MYT

LAGOS (Reuters) - A British university has postponed the return of more than 100 Benin Bronzes to Nigeria after a presidential decree named a royal ruler as the owner and custodian of all returned artefacts, the head of museums and monuments said on Wednesday.

Nigeria is on a quest to get thousands of intricate bronze sculptures and castings that were looted by British soldiers during a raid on the then-separate Kingdom of Benin, located in what is now southwestern Nigeria, in 1897.

But an official gazette signed by President Muhammadu Buhari on March 28 said the Oba of Benin was the rightful owner of all returned Benin Bronzes and was responsible for the management of all places where the artefacts were kept.

Abba Isa Tijani, director general of Nigeria's National Commission for Museums and Monuments said the University of Cambridge's Museum of Archaeology and Anthropology had planned to return 116 artefacts this month but this was put on hold after the decree started circulating last month.

REUTERS, VIA THE STAR · 11 MAY 2023

Returning the bronzes

2022–2023 · News reports · Clippings

October 2022: 29 objects go back from the Smithsonian. March 2023: Nigeria's president names the Oba of Benin owner. May 2023: returns stall over who should receive them. Full articles are on the desk.